

# Chicago Tribune



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TUESDAY, FEBRUARY 25, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

## Former Gov. Edgar diagnosed with cancer

Two-term governor led Ill. through period of fiscal austerity

By Rick Pearson  
Chicago Tribune

Jim Edgar, who led Illinois government through a period of fiscal austerity with great positive acclaim from voters during his two terms as governor, announced Monday that he has been diagnosed with pancreatic cancer.

Edgar, 78, who served as the state's chief executive from 1991 to 1999 and currently leads a bipartisan program through the University of Illinois aimed at training the state's future political leaders, made the announcement in a brief note to past "Edgar Fellows" participants.

He wrote he and his wife, Brenda, "are facing a new, significant challenge."

"Doctors at Rush University Medical Center in Chicago have determined I have pancreatic cancer that has spread. They and physicians at Mayo Clinic are coordinating on a treatment regimen that I am following initially in Arizona, where we spend the winter, and later in Springfield when we return," Edgar wrote.

"We do not underestimate this challenge, but we have confidence in the medical team helping us address it," he wrote.

In an interview, Edgar said he was diagnosed in mid-January following an MRI and biopsy and has so far undergone three chemotherapy treatments.

"I guess I'm still kind of in denial so I can kind of get by each day," the former governor said, noting doctors at Mayo told him that life-extending treatments have been advancing quickly over the last five years.

"It just came out of the blue. I didn't have any symptoms or anything. A guy at Mayo told me, 'Anybody that tells you you've got so long to live, don't believe it. Nobody knows how long you've got.' He said, 'You'll hear about an average. Nobody's average.' He said, 'It's either worse or better,'" Edgar said.

"I told him, 'Guys, I'm a pessimist. I lost my first election, but I don't want to die,'" he said, adding that two of his grandchildren have wedding plans this year. "I also said, 'There's an old saying in horse racing — if you

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## Jury selection begins for Crimo trial

Jury selection began Monday in the case of Robert Crimo III, who is charged in the mass shooting that killed seven people at the 2022 Independence Day parade in Highland Park.

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## Tariff wars leave small firms exposed

Such businesses employ half of the U.S. workforce, so how they cope with Trump's ramped-up trade war will be crucial to the wider economic impact. **Business**

## Trump backs Musk accountability email

President Donald Trump voices support for Elon Musk's demand that federal employees explain their recent accomplishments or risk getting fired. **Nation & World**



A woman reacts at a makeshift memorial for the fallen Ukrainian and foreign fighters on the Independence Square in Kyiv on Monday during the third anniversary of Russia's invasion of Ukraine. **SERGEI SUPINSKY/GETTY-AFP**

# Kyiv marks grinding war's 3rd anniversary

US, European allies divided in UN votes regarding Ukraine

By Justin Spike  
Associated Press

KYIV, Ukraine — Ukraine on Monday marked the bleakest anniversary yet of its war against the Russia invasion, with the country's forces under severe pressure on the battlefield and President Donald Trump's administration apparently embracing the Kremlin in a reversal of U.S. policy.

A display of the shift in

trans-Atlantic relations under Trump played out in the U.N. as the United States split with its European allies by refusing to blame Russia for its invasion of Ukraine in votes on three resolutions Monday seeking an end to the three-year war.

In the U.N. General Assembly, the U.S. joined Russia in voting against a Europe-backed Ukrainian resolution that calls out Moscow's aggression and demands an immediate with-

drawal of Russian troops.

The U.S. then abstained from voting on its own competing resolution after Europeans, led by France, succeeded in amending it to make clear that Russia was the aggressor. The voting was taking place as Trump was hosting French President Emmanuel Macron in Washington.

It was a major setback for the Trump administration in the 193-member world body, whose resolutions are not legally bind-

ing but are seen as a barometer of world opinion.

The U.S. then pushed for a vote on its original draft in the more powerful U.N. Security Council, where resolutions are legally binding and it has veto power along with Russia, China, Britain and France. The vote in the 15-member council was 10-0 with five countries abstaining, all from Europe.

Meanwhile in Kyiv ahead of the U.N. votes, the three-year

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Jason Klein, co-founder of Spiteful Brewing in the Bowmanville neighborhood, at the brewery on Monday. He said the 13-year-old brewery sells a half-million cans each year, all imported from Canada through a supplier. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

# Chicago craft brewers expect tariffs to raise price of a six-pack

By Robert Channick  
Chicago Tribune

When two northwest suburban childhood hockey pals launched Spiteful Brewing in 2012 as a post-collegiate enterprise, the business overcame long odds to grow from a stove-top startup into an award-winning craft brewery and tap room in Bowmanville.

But after successfully navigating everything from the pandemic to a flat craft brewing market that has forced several Chicago competitors to close,

Spiteful faces an imminent new challenge: tariffs.

President Donald Trump's 25% tariffs on imported aluminum, set to go into place March 12, will raise the cost to produce every whimsically adorned can of Spiteful beer, from its Working for the Weekend Double IPA to its Fat Badger Ale.

For Spiteful and other Chicago craft brewers, the results may be inevitable: libation inflation.

"Imagine something that you're buying every day goes up 25% overnight," said Jason

Klein, 42, co-founder of Spiteful Brewing. "We would have no choice but to raise prices — there's no way we can absorb that."

A niche segment of the beer industry, craft brewing has become big business in Illinois, with hundreds of mostly small manufacturers generating \$3.1 billion in economic impact in the state in 2023, according to the Brewers Association, a Colorado-based trade group. But after years of explosive

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## Egg prices skyrocket as paczki craze approaches

Increase has put strain on production costs for area bakeries

By Samantha Moilanen  
Daily Southtown

With Fat Thursday and Fat Tuesday just around the corner, bakeries across the Chicago area are gearing up for the annual rush of paczki orders, but many are facing challenges due to soaring egg prices.

Slawa Dudek, a manager at Olympia Bakery in Hickory Hills, said the bakery has been preparing paczki dough since early February.

At the European bakery, Dudek said the paczki dough is a traditional recipe brought from Poland by her aunt and uncle, the bakery owners. Because the process is time-consuming, she said the bakery prepares the dough in advance and freezes it.

"It is an old recipe," Dudek said. "The dough has to be rolled by hand."

Come Fat Thursday and Fat Tuesday, the bakery fries the dough and fills the paczki with a variety of traditional Central European flavors like rose hip and prune, as well as popular American choices such as raspberry, custard, fresh strawberry and cream, lemon, and apple.

However, the rising cost of eggs, a key ingredient in both the

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